

Yuè & the Sinitic Languages of the Pearl River Region — Unit 4.1

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Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà



Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

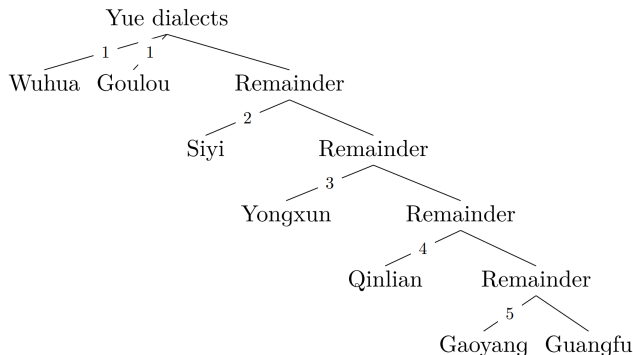


Figure 2.6: LAC Classification of Yue dialects (Tree representation), based on Wu (2007)

Sung, Ho Wang Matthew. 2026. *Advancing Explanatory and Tonal Dialectometry* (LOT 709). Amsterdam: Landelijke Onderzoekschool Taalwetenschap. <https://doi.org/10.48273/L0T0709>

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陈虹羽 & 甘于恩. 2023. 粤语“吴化片”成片问题再探讨–以粤西吴川地区常用词为例. *Modern Chinese* 现代语文 2023(3). 58–65.

Internternal classification of Yuè-Píng huà

	Wuhua	Goulou	Siyi	Yongxun	Qinlian	Gaoyang	Guangfu
1. MC* [+voi, -cont] > [-voi, +s.g.]	+	-	±	±	±	±	±
2. MC *tʰ- > h-	-	-	+	-	-	-	-
3. Have contrastive [i] and [ɪ]	±	-	+/-	+	-	-	-
4. No Yin-Yang distinction for Shang/ Qu	-	-	-	-	+	-	-
5. MC *s- > [ʃ] or [θ]	+	+/-	+/-	+/-	+	+	-

Figure 2.5: LAC Classification Criteria (modified from Wu 2007)

1. [MC voiced plosive/affricate initials:] 勾漏片 [...] 今基本读不送气清音；吴化片今一律读送气清音；[others] 今逢平、上声调读送气清音，逢去、入声调读不送气清音
2. 四邑片古透母字今读清喉擦音 [h-]
3. 邕浔片止摄开口齿音字韵母精庄、知章不同类，部分方言拥有舌尖元音韵母 [ɿ] 或 [ʮ]
4. 钦廉片上声、去声均只有一类
5. 高阳片古心母字今读舌尖中边擦音 [ʃ-] (*LAC2 moved 5 to btw 2 & 3*)

Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

(As discussed in §3.2:)

Northern Pínghuà: “Mandarinised”

Southern Pínghuà: LAC2 only raises one trait distinguishing

Southern Pínghuà from Gōulòu Yuè (覃远雄 2012: 155)

精、清、从、邪与知、庄、章组合并为一套塞擦音

[MC ts, ts^h, dz, z & t, tʃ, tɕ groups merged as one affricate]

Southern Pínghuà: largely true

Gōulòu Yuè: only largely true only for Guǎngxī Gōulòu Yuè

MC >	將 tsjaŋ ^A	章 tɕjaŋ ^A
南寧位子淥 平	tʃɛŋ ^{A1}	tʃɛŋ ^{A1}
(三江古宜平)	(tsjəŋ ^{A1})	(tɕəŋ ^{A1})
玉林粵	ɕa ^{A1}	tɕa ^{A1}
蒙山粵	θjɿŋ ^{A1}	tʃjɿ ^{A1}
(德興粵)	(tsen ^{A1})	(tsen ^{A1})

Interinternal classification of Yuè-Pínghuà

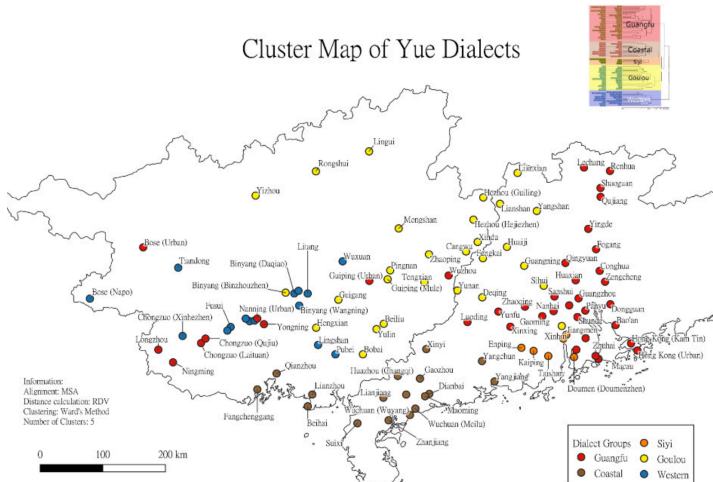


Figure 6.5: Cluster Map of Yue Dialects in Guangdong and Guangxi (MSA)

Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

Rank	Variant	Feature	nPMI	Exclusivity	Representativeness
1	œ	œ_leg	0.709	0.821	0.865
2	j	*j_meat	0.694	0.773	0.919
3	j	*j_moon	0.687	0.8	0.865
4	œ	œ_bird_col	0.685	0.816	0.838
5	œ	œ_long	0.682	0.8	0.865
6	œ	œ_to think	0.682	0.8	0.865
7	j	*j_sun	0.67	0.767	0.892
8	j	*j_person	0.65	0.75	0.892
9	j	*j_fish	0.623	0.756	0.838
10	y	y_village	0.607	0.727	0.865
11	j	*j_hot	0.577	0.744	0.784
12	j	*j_two	0.575	0.757	0.757
13	y	y_all	0.51	0.66	0.838
14	y	y_pig	0.494	0.618	0.919
15	ts ^h	*dz_all	0.493	0.6	0.973
16	y	y_feather	0.493	0.6	0.973
17	j	*j_ear	0.472	0.684	0.703
18	y	y_tree	0.465	0.593	0.946
19	ɔ	ɔ_to speak_col	0.462	0.581	0.973
20	∅	leg_m	0.455	0.6	0.892

nPMI
[normalised
Pointwise
Mutual
Information]:
high nPMI =
high joint
probability of
observing the
dialect group
and the variant
together (Sung
2026: 107)

Table 6.1: Top 20 Features in Guangfu Yue Dialects. * represents re-constructed historical value of the segment (see Section 6.4).

Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

Rank	Variant	Feature	nPMI	Exclusivity	Representativeness
1	h	*d_head	0.946	0.857	1
2	h	*t ^h _soil/earth	0.946	0.857	1
3	p	*-t_knee	0.94	1	0.833
4	ŋg	*n_meat	0.94	1	0.833
5	ŋg	*n_sun	0.94	1	0.833
6	ŋg	*n_hot	0.88	0.833	0.833
7	ŋg	*n_moon	0.88	0.833	0.833
8	i	night_m	0.875	1	0.667
9	ŋg	*n_person	0.875	1	0.667
10	ŋg	*n_to drink	0.875	1	0.667
11	ŋg	*n_ear	0.829	0.714	0.833
12	ŋg	*n_fish	0.829	0.714	0.833
13	ŋg	*n_two	0.829	0.714	0.833
14	z	*n_enter	0.807	0.8	0.667
15	z	j_feather	0.807	0.8	0.667
16	z	j_leaf	0.807	0.8	0.667
17	z	j_night	0.807	0.8	0.667
18	z	j_one	0.807	0.8	0.667
19	z	j_rain	0.807	0.8	0.667
20	z	j_round	0.807	0.8	0.667

Table 6.2: Top 20 Features in Siyi Yue Dialects. * represents reconstructed historical value of the segment (see Section 6.4).

Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

Rank	Variant	Feature	nPMI	Exclusivity	Representativeness
1	u	w_cloud	0.767	0.917	0.647
2	u	*y_yellow	0.697	0.9	0.529
3	f	*y_lake	0.672	0.6	0.882
4	i	y_tree	0.67	0.6	0.882
5	i	y_fish	0.664	0.65	0.765
6	ei	y_tool	0.635	1	0.353
7	i	y_rain	0.634	0.583	0.824
8	i	y_mouse/rat	0.632	0.583	0.824
9	i	y_village	0.623	0.75	0.529
10	i	y_pig	0.614	0.56	0.824
11	i	bird_lit_m	0.578	0.857	0.353
12	i	y_feather	0.561	0.484	0.882
13	ei	*y_woman	0.556	1	0.235
14	ei	*i_teacher	0.555	1	0.235
15	ei	y_to go	0.555	1	0.235
16	?	*-t_eight	0.537	0.833	0.294
17	?	*-t_hair_head	0.537	0.833	0.294
18	?	*-t_to kill	0.537	0.833	0.294
19	au	iu_bird_lit	0.534	0.833	0.294
20	u	liver_m	0.517	0.615	0.471

Table 6.3: Top 20 Features in Coastal Yue Dialects. * represents reconstructed historical value of the segment (see Section 6.4).

Internternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

Rank	Variant	Feature	nPMI	Exclusivity	Representativeness
1	œ	ɔ_to speak_col	0.536	1	0.321
2	œ	ɔ_horn	0.534	1	0.321
3	∅	*x_red	0.512	1	0.286
4	∅	*ɣ_to merge	0.512	1	0.286
5	∅	*ɣ_summer	0.508	1	0.286
6	ts	*k_nine	0.5	0.737	0.5
7	θ	s_knee	0.486	1	0.25
8	au	ɐu_mouth	0.48	0.833	0.357
9	au	ɐu_hand	0.466	0.889	0.286
10	au	ɐu_autumn	0.464	0.889	0.286
11	au	ɐu_nine	0.464	0.889	0.286
12	θ	*d_to sit	0.458	1	0.214
13	p	f_tomb	0.456	1	0.214
14	au	ɐu_dog	0.448	0.769	0.357
15	t ^h	*ts ^h _autumn	0.446	0.684	0.464
16	p	*b_skin1	0.438	0.581	0.643
17	a	ɐ_enter	0.437	0.875	0.25
18	θ	s_four	0.437	0.875	0.25
19	θ	s_heart	0.437	0.875	0.25
20	θ	s_new	0.437	0.875	0.25

Table 6.4: Top 20 Features in Goulou Yue Dialects. * represents reconstructed historical value of the segment (see Section 6.4).

Interinternal classification of Yuè–Pínghuà

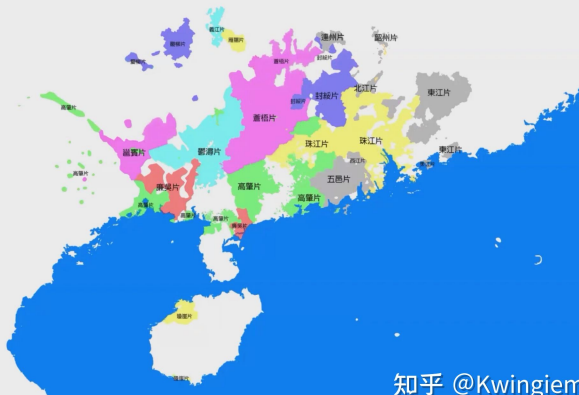
Rank	Variant	Feature	nPMI	Exclusivity	Representativeness
1	i	ɛ_snake	0.902	0.882	0.938
2	j	*y_summer	0.865	1	0.75
3	ɲ	*ŋ_to bite	0.865	0.929	0.812
4	ŋ	*ŋ_five	0.844	0.789	0.938
5	h	*y_lake	0.83	0.727	1
6	h	*h_tiger	0.818	0.75	0.938
7	h	*h_fire	0.8	0.812	0.812
8	h	*y_yellow	0.795	0.857	0.75
9	u	ɔ_to sit	0.794	0.917	0.688
10	ui	y_pig	0.765	1	0.562
11	ui	y_rain	0.765	1	0.562
12	ui	y_mouse/rat	0.764	1	0.562
13	ui	y_tree	0.764	1	0.562
14	o	œ_double	0.761	0.8	0.75
15	ɲ	*ŋ_tooth1	0.759	0.846	0.688
16	h	j_rain	0.746	0.652	0.938
17	a	ɔ_to speak_col	0.746	0.652	0.938
18	o	ɔ_yellow	0.733	0.75	0.75
19	əu	ɐu_cow	0.73	1	0.5
20	əu	ɐu_hand	0.73	1	0.5

Table 6.5: Top 20 Features in Western Yue Dialects. * represents re-constructed historical value of the segment (see Section 6.4).

Internternal classification of Yuè-Pínghuà

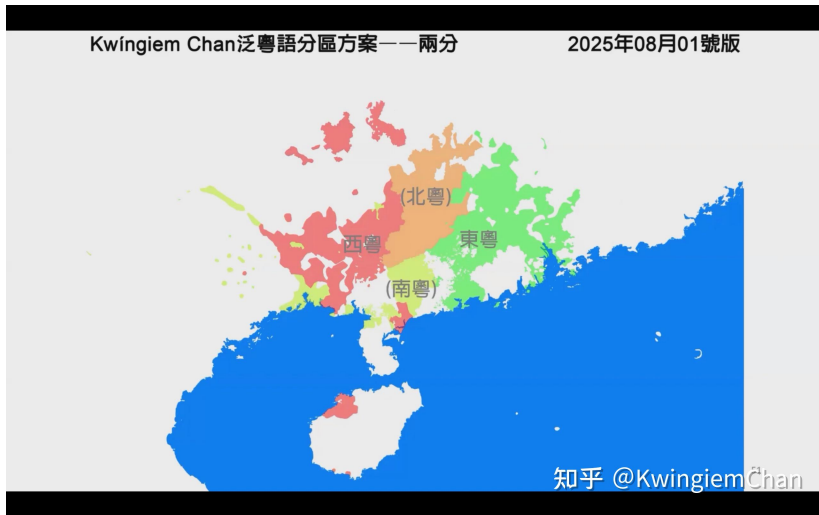
Kwingiem Chan 泛粵語分區方案——小區

2025年08月01號版



知乎 @KwingiemChan⁴⁹

Internternal classification of Yuè-Pínghuà



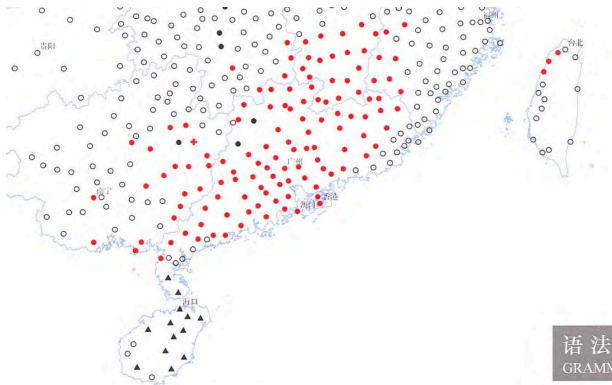
West-East lexical/grammatical differences

(Maps from the *Linguistic Atlas of Chinese Dialects* 《汉语方言地图集》)

是他~老师
The Copula *shì* ("to be")

- 是 ● 係
▲ 是[t-]^① ★ 係~是
● 是[dz-]^②

① “是[t-]”表示读[t dʰ]声母。
② “是[dz-]”表示读塞擦音声母，
包括[dz ts tsʰ dz tɕ tɕʰ tʃ]。

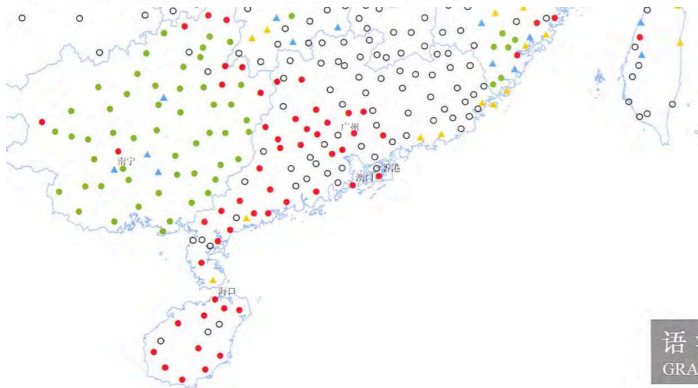


West-East lexical/grammatical differences

问问 (方) 单音节动词重叠: 你去~^①
Reduplicated Single-syllable Verbs

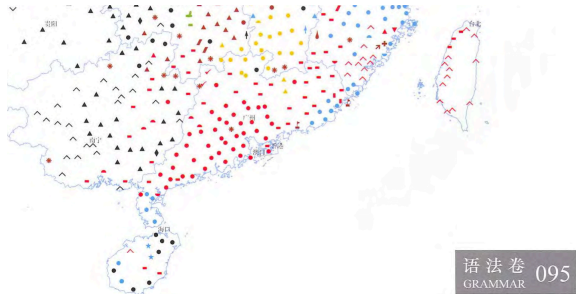
- 问问 ▲ 问问看 ● 问问~问问看 ▲ 问问下 ○ 无重叠—般说“问一下”、“问一下”
▲ 问问~问问看看 ▼ 问问去 ■ 问问起

①图例里“看”、“下”是代号，“看”的具体说法见语法卷091图，“下”代表动量词。



West-East lexical/grammatical differences

被				
衣服一破就走了 The Passive Marker <i>bèi</i>				
● 被	▲ 给	✱ 要	● 叫	▲ 把
↓ 遭	✱ 给~被	2 要因	✱ 叫~被	✱ 把得
↓ 遭~要	▼ 给~界	✱ 央	↓ 叫~让	✱ 摆
↗ 挺	✱ 给~回	● 乞	✱ 叫~看	↓ 拽
↗ 挺~看	✱ 给~拽	● 乞~互	✱ 叫~刀	↓ 拽~拽
▲ 看	✱ 给~闻	● 乞~度	✱ 让	↓ 拽勒
看~被	● 界	↓ 讨	↓ 让~被	● 拿
● 看~拿给	● 界~看	↓ 讨~拖	↓ 让~看	● 拿~奔
	▼ 界~分	▲ 等	✱ 让~把	● 拿给
	✱ 分	● 等~把	✱ 让把	● 拿得
	✱ 分~乞	● 等~垮		● 拿给
	✱ 分~得			
	✓ 渠			
	✓ 渠			

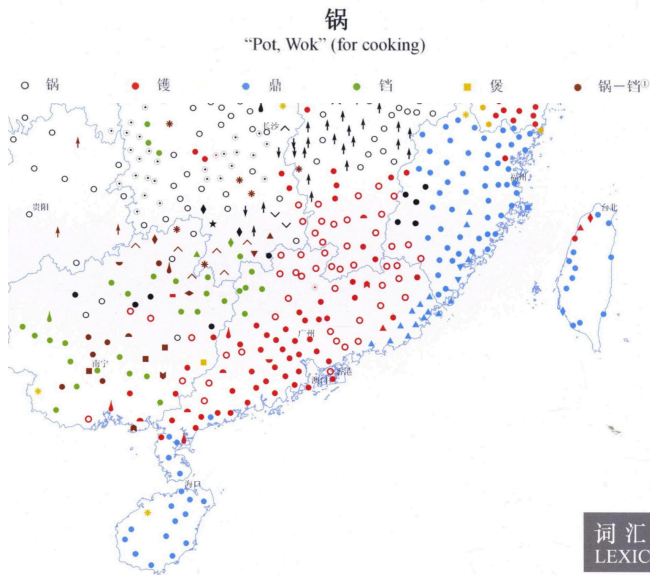


吃~食
“Eat (a meal)”

○ 吃^① ● 吃^② ● 吃^③ ● 吃^④ ▲ 吃^⑤
 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃
 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃 ▲ 吃~吃

① “吃”表示声母符合组，韵母符合。
 ② “吃”表示声母符合组，韵母符合，湖南等地写作“吃”
 ③ “吃”表示声母符合组，韵母符合，又符合组，韵母符合。
 ④ “吃”表示声母符合组，韵母符合，又符合组，韵母符合。
 ⑤ “吃”表示声母符合组，韵母符合，又符合组，韵母符合。

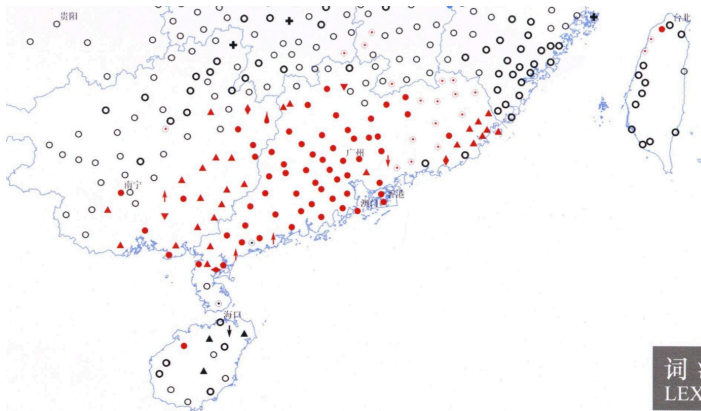
West-East lexical/grammatical differences



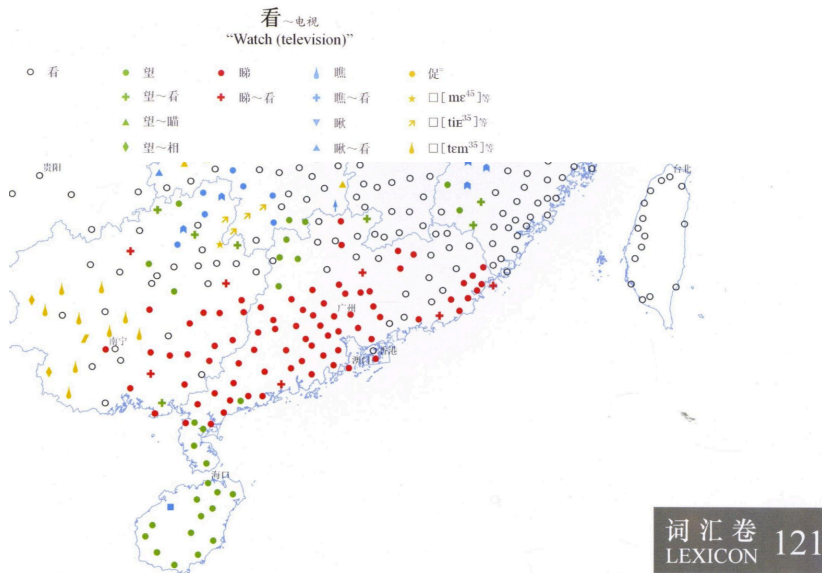
West-East lexical/grammatical differences

雨傘 “Umbrella”

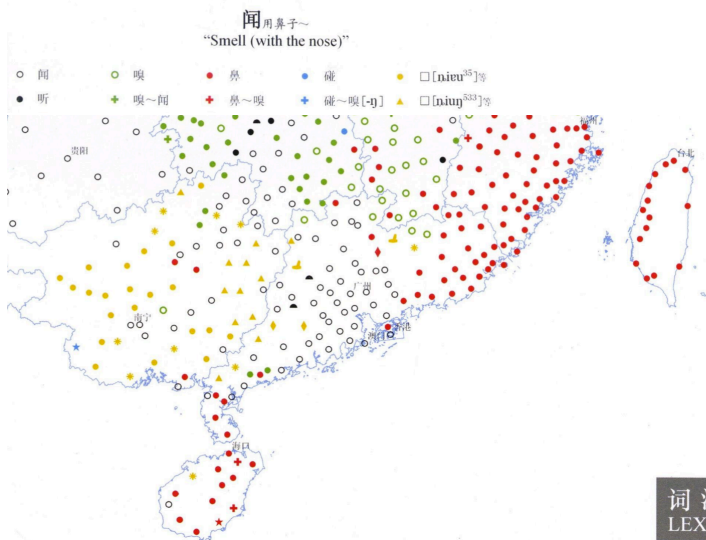
- | | | |
|---------|-------|--------|
| ○ 雨傘 | ● 遮 | ● 雨蓋 |
| + 雨傘~傘 | ▲ 遮~傘 | ▲ 雨蓋~傘 |
| ↑ 雨傘~洋傘 | ● 遮一 | ▲ 豎笠 |
| ↓ 雨傘~布傘 | ▲ 雨遮 | ◆ 雨件 |



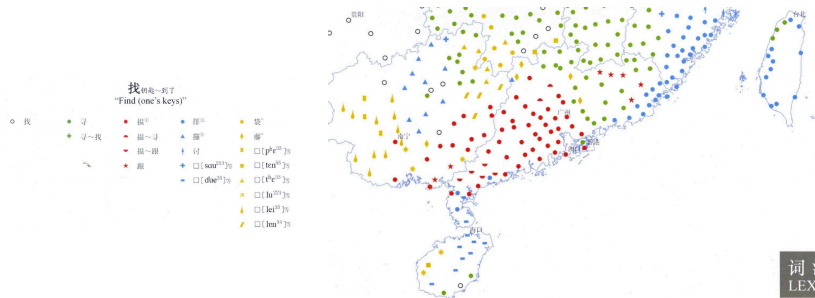
West-East lexical/grammatical differences



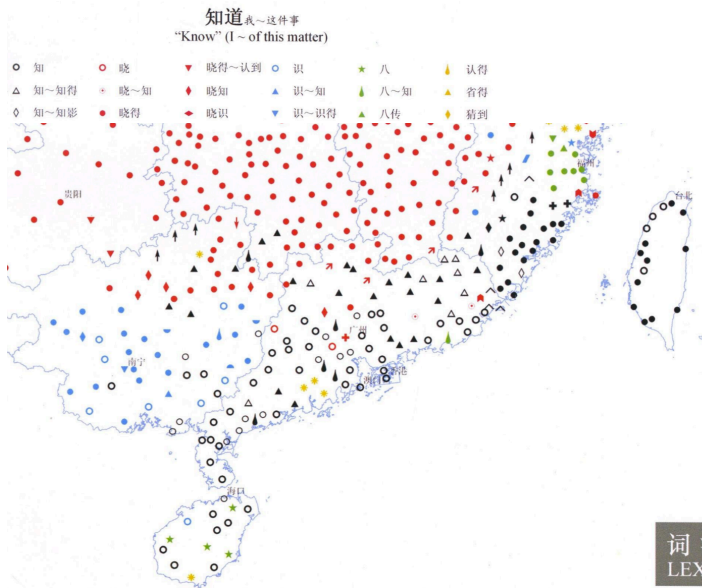
West-East lexical/grammatical differences



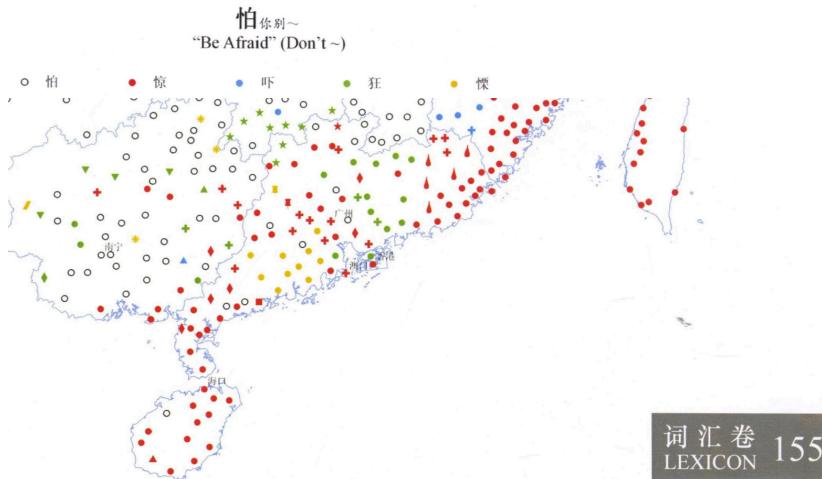
West-East lexical/grammatical differences



West-East lexical/grammatical differences



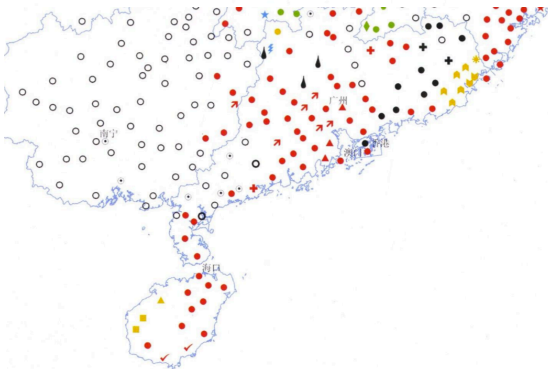
West-East lexical/grammatical differences



West-East lexical/grammatical differences

睡 他已经~了
“Sleep” (He is already ~ing)

- | | | | | |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|-----|
| ○ 睡 | ● 睏 | ★ 眠 | ● 歇 | ▲ 舢 |
| ○ 睡~睡觉 | + 睏~睡 | ■ 眠~眠熟 | ▲ 歇~歇觉 | ● 瞌 |
| + 睡~睡目 | ▲ 睏~睡觉 | ▲ 眠熟 | ◆ 歇觉 | ■ 倒 |

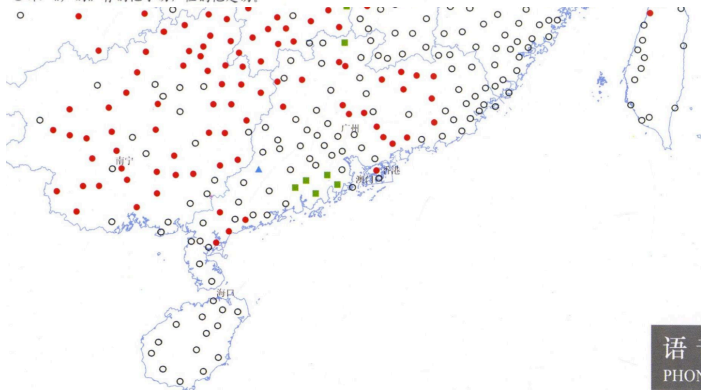


West-East lexical/grammatical differences

听^①特字的声调 The Tone of *tīng*

○ 来自平声 ● 来自去声 ▲ 来自平声~去声 ■ 来自平声或去声

①听:《广韵》青韵他丁切,径韵他定切。



West-East lexical/grammatical differences

鼻特字的声调①
The Tone of *bí*

